

The Candlelight Fisherman (Sue/Monty version – refrain, removed chorus, re-word)

Refrain (repeat after every verse):

He'd open the pane and pop out the flame. Just to see how the wind do blow.

START: Every time I think of this next story, I can't help thinking of a beach and some fishing boats from times past here on the Island. Somewhere like the Fisherman's cottage in Shanklin, perhaps, though the winds around there maybe don't behave quite like the way they do in this tale...

It's the story of a man who's spent his life working hard, a fisherman by trade, just as his father, and his father's father had done before him. And because he'd worked always, it often seemed harder now. Because he still **had** to go fishing; not because he wanted to, not because he enjoyed it, but because he still **had to**. Because there were no pensions in those days. So he would go fishing if go fishing he must, though he increasingly looked for a reason not to.

Oh me dad was a fisherman bold. And he lived until he grew old. For...

~~And his poor wife says to him. We shall starve if you don't go. So...~~

And he'd often say to me
You'd be wise before you go. [So...]

BUT TODAY, TODAY WAS A GOOD DAY. A BEAUTIFUL DAY. THE SUN WAS SHINING, AND THE BREEZE WAS JUST RIGHT, AND HE WAS HAPPY TO GO...

NOT MUCH LUCK, THEN CAUGHT FLOUNDER... "PLEASE LET ME GO."

THREW IT BACK.

TOLD HIS WIFE...

AND SHE LOOKED AT HIM, DESPAIRINGLY.

"DID YOU NOT THINK," SHE SAID... "A TALKING FISH. A MAGIC FISH, DID YOU NOT THINK THAT MAYBE YOU MIGHT GET SOMETHING IN RETURN?" AND HE ADMITTED THAT HE DID NOT.

"YOU'RE WHOLE LIFE YOU'VE WORKED HARD", SHE SAID, "AND LOOK AT WHERE WE LIVE?" THATCH, DOOR, WINDOW PANE.

GO BACK TO THAT FISH TOMORROW, ASK FOR A WISH. ASK THAT WE MIGHT NOT HAVE TO LIVE IN SUCH A HOVEL.

BUT HE WAS NOT KEEN TO GO.

SO THE NEXT MORNING, HE CHECKED THE WIND, TO SEE IF HWE COULD FIND AN EXCUSE NOT TO GO...

When the **South** wind soft do blow. Then there's not enough wind to go. But...

And his **dear** wife says to him. We'll not know if you don't go. So...

AND MAYBE SHE WAS RIGHT, AND MAYBE SHE WAS WRONG, BUT HE KNEW HE'D HAVE TO GO ANYWAY...

HE WENT ROUND THE CORNER, AND PULLED OUT THE BOAT, A SLIGHT SWELL ON THE SEA WHERE IT HAD BEEN LIKE A MILLPOND THE DAY BEFORE, AND WENT TO THE PLACE HE'D CAUGHT THE FLOUNDER.

LIVE IN SOMETHING RATHER BETTER THAN THE HOVEL WE LIVE IN NOW?

IT IS DONE.

PRETTY COTTAGE.....

THEY WERE COMFORTABLE THERE, BUT GIVEN A TASTE OF A GOOD LIFE, THE FISHERMAN'S WIFE NOW WANTED MORE. AND SAID TO HER HUSBAND... I KNOW THIS IS NICE, BUT IT'S NOT FAIR, IS IT. THEM'S THAT HAS, ALWAYS HAS. WHO GAVE THEM THE RIGHT TO BE LORDS AND LADIES? WHY SHOULDN'T YOU BE LORD OF THE MANOR? WHY SHOULDN'T I BE THE LADY? YOU GO AND TELL THAT FISH WE SHOULD BE LORD AND LADY OF THE MANOR, AND LIVE UP IN THE MANOR HOUSE, NOT DOWN HERE BY THE BEACH.

HE TRIED TO MAKE HIS EXCUSES, OF COURSE HE DID, BUT IT DID HIM NO GOOD; AND WHEN HE GOT UP THE NEXT MORNING HE LOOKED FOR ANOTHER EXCUSE NOT TO GO.

When the wind comes out of the **East**. It's no use to man nor beast. But...

BUT IT DID HIM NO GOOD...

And his **posh** wife says to him. We'll regret (it) if you don't go. So...

THE SKY WAS GREY, AND THE SEA WAS GREY, AS HE SET OFF THAT MORNING, ROUND THE CORNER, TO PULL THE BOAT OUT.

PLEASE – MANOR HOUSE – OK...

GOT BACK...

NOT HAPPY... YOU CAN'T MOVE FOR MANOR HOUSES ON THE ISLAND. WE DESERVE BETTER THAN THAT. FOR ALL WE'VE DONE FOR THE PEOPLE OF THIS MANOR, WE DESERVE MORE. WE SHOULD LIVE UP AT THE CASTLE, CARISBROOKE CASTLE, AS CAPTAINS OF THE ISLAND.

AND AS THE FISHERMAN SHOULD HIS HEAD, HIS WIFE SHOOK HER FINGER...

WHEN HE AWOKE THE NEXT MORNING, A STORM WAS BREWING.... AND HE CHECKED THE WIND...

When the wind is back in the **West**. That'll come in rough at best. But...

And his **fine** wife says to him. You'll regret (it) if you don't go. So...

AND HE KNEW THERE WAS NO POINT PROTESTING...

PURPLE SKY, PURPLE SEA... OUT – ASK FOR CASTLE – RETURN

WANTED MORE (KING)

AND HE PROTESTED AS MUCH AS HE COULD, BUT HE KNEW HE'D HAVE TO GET UP EARLY THE NEXT MORNING....

When the **North** wind rough do blow. Then I lay right snug below. But...

REALLY, REALLY – ISN'T THIS ENOUGH? YOU KNOW YOU DON'T EVEN LIKE LEAVING THE ISLAND? WHY WOULD YOU WANT US TO LEAVE THE ISLAND TO GO OVER TO THE MAINLAND????

And his **Lady** says to him. You will pay if you don't go. So...

SO HE SET OFF.... FOUND FISH – GO HOME – AND HE DID...

Now all you fishermen bold. If you live until you grow old. Do you open...